Cascade

LEVERAGE: An AI Track

1. CONTEXT

Every person runs a private system every day.

They wake up with limited time, limited energy, limited money, competing obligations, unfinished tasks, emotional drag, and dozens of tiny decisions that shape the rest of the day. Most people do not fail because they lack ambition. They fail because the underlying structure of their life ispoorly organized.

The problem is not one task. It is the system underneath the tasks. A missed alarm ripples into a late start. A late start compresses the day. Compression creates stress. Stress causes bad decisions. Bad decisions create more backlog. The system compounds.This track asks teams to build tools that make those invisible patterns visible, manageable, and optimizable. The goal is not to motivate the user. The goal is to help them understand the machinery of their own life and improve it with leverage. That directly matches the document's focus on planning, hidden architecture, optimization, and structural control.

2. WHAT WENT WRONG?

Most people manage life reactively.

They keep calendars, notes, reminders, finance apps, habit trackers, and to-do lists, but these tools rarely talk to each other. So the person still cannot answer the real questions:

- What is actually blocking progress?
- Which habits are feeding my stress?
- Where is my time leaking?
- What should I automate, defer, or remove?
- What decision would unlock the most downstream benefit?

The result is fragmentation. The user sees symptoms, not structure.

3. THE CORE PROBLEM

Build a system that helps an individual answer three urgent questions:

What is the real structure of my life right now?

Can the system map the dependencies between sleep, work, money, focus, relationships, errands, and commitments?

Where is the biggest leverage point?

Can it identify bottlenecks, recurring failure loops, and high-cost decisions that keep causing downstream chaos?

How do I make my life more governable without making it rigid?

Can it turn scattered routines into a clearer operating model with rules, workflows, priorities, and automation?

4. THE STRATEGIC QUESTION

How can a person see the hidden architecture of their own life, detect the most important constraints, and use better structure to create more stability, efficiency, and long-term progress?

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5. WHAT DO YOU NEED TO DELIVER

Every team must submit all of the following. Both components carry equal weight in judging.

1. Problem Diagnosis

A crisp summary of what is breaking in the individual's system, why it keeps breaking, and the single biggest leverage point for improvement.

2. Personal Leverage Model

A complete, commercially viable or technically viable strategy that includes:

A life dependency map

Show how major domains connect: time, energy, money, attention, health, work, learning, and relationships.

A bottleneck detection framework

Identify where the user is stuck most often and what triggers the failure loop.

A decision and planning layer

Suggest what should be done now, what should be delayed, and what should be delegated, automated, or removed.

A resource allocation model

Help the user distribute limited time and energy across priorities with better judgment.

A rule-based system or automation layer

Convert repeated choices into reusable policies, routines, or alerts.

3. Working Prototype

A functional build that brings at least one core part of your solution to life. It could be:

- A dashboard that visualizes the user's personal system and key dependencies
- A planner that recommends the best next action based on time, energy, and urgency
- A bottleneck detector that spots recurring leaks in attention, money, or schedule
- A simulation tool that shows how one decision affects the rest of the week
- A rules engine that automates routine decisions or re-plans when conditions change

Your prototype does not need to be fully polished. It needs to be real enough that a person could actually use it to understand and improve their life.

6. HOW YOU WILL BE JUDGED

WHAT WE MEASURE	CURRENT STATE	TARGET
Visibility into personal constraints	Low	High
Time lost to reactive decisions	High	Reduced
Ability to detect bottlenecks early	Weak	Strong
Quality of personal planning	Fragmented	Structured
Usefulness of recommendations	Generic	Actionable

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CRITERIA

- **Problem Understanding:** Do you understand that the real issue is not *productivity* alone, but the structure underneath the person's choices?
- **Leverage Quality:** Do you identify the highest-impact intervention point?
- **Prototype Quality:** Does the tool actually help a person make better decisions or reduce chaos?
- **Practical Value:** Can this be used by a real individual in daily life without becoming too complex?